

- The temporary speed limit should encourage uniform speed of travel.
- Speeds should be low enough to allow road users time to react to signs, directions, traffic control or unusual events.
- The temporary speed limit must not be so low that a significant number of road users disregard it.
- Temporary speed limits may be a compromise where conditions vary over a length of road.
- The length of the temporary speed zone should be as shown in Table 5.5.
- The speed limit applied to the zone must not exceed the maximum safe speed of travel at which traffic can safely traverse the site. The maximum safe speed of travel depends on a number of factors including:
 - 6 number and type of vehicles
 - 7 number of pedestrians / cyclists
 - 8 type of works undertaken
 - 9 extent of the works
 - 10 road characteristics
 - 11 number of incidences, conflicts or hazards on the road. Where the frequency of incidents, conflicts or hazards on a road increase, the maximum safe speed of travel needs to be reviewed.

The Designer should ensure reduced speed zones are as short as possible and that they are not commenced so far prior to the hazard (or workers) that drivers start to disregard them and speed up. There is a balance between ensuring drivers can reduce speed prior to a hazard and not making that distance so long that compliance becomes an issue.

Speed limits implemented to meet specified safe workplace requirements for the protection of workers in an active work area should commence a minimum of a single sign spacing in advance of the active work area. The 200 m zone requirements past a speed limit reduction apply when determining this sign spacing value.

When considering the extent of the reduced speed beyond the work area, the guidance in Section 5.12 should be used, while remembering that offset speed zone requirements and the need to reduce traffic speeds past the work area for the other direction of travel may dictate the speed sign locations.